their comming out.

The Archbishoppe of Canterburie beeyng sore offended with Earle Iohn the kings brother, for taking to wife Isabel Countesse of Glocester, his cousin in the third degree, wrote a threatning letter to the same Iohn, commaunding him not to touch the virgine, and to appeare at a peremptory day before him to answere the matter. The 15. of December at Pipwell, in presence of the king, the Archbishop and prelates were elected, Geffery de Lucy to the sea of Winchester, Richarde Archdeacon of Ely, the Kings treasurer, to the sea of London, Hubert Waltar to Salisburie, William Longchampe, the Kinges Chancellor to Ely, and Geffery the K. bastard brother, to the sea of Yorke.

K. Richard gaue the Castles of Berwike and Rokelburgh to the Scottish K. for the summe of x. M. pound: he also sold to Hugo de Puteaco Bish. of Durham, his own prouince for a great piece of money, and created him Earle of the same, and then sayde in game, I am a wonderous craftesman, I haue made a newe Earle of an old Bishop. He solde the priory of Couentrie, to Hugh Bishop of Chester, for iii. C. marks, which Hugh with a power of armed men, inuaded the Priory, chased the Prior away, beate the Monkes, lamed some, cast some into prison, and spoyling the other, droue them away, brake the hutches of the Church, brent their Charters and priuileges.

The king also fayned to haue lost his signet, and made a newe, and then caused to bee proclaimed, that who so euer woulde safely enioy those thinges which before time they had inrolled, shoulde come to the newe seale, whereby it came to passe, that many which could not find him in England, went ouer sea to fine with him at his pleasure.

In this time were many robbers and out-lawes, among the which, Robert Hood, and lytle Iohn, renowmed theeues, continued in woods, dispoyling and robbing the goods of the rich. They killed none but such as would inuade them, or by resistance for their owne defence. Iohn Maior. Outlawes in England.

The said Robert intertained an hundred tall men, and good archers, with such spoyles and thefts as he got, vpon whome foure hundred (were they neuer so strong,) durst not giue the onset. Hee suffered no woman to bee oppressed, violated, or otherwise molested: poore mens goodes hee spared, aboundantly releeuing them with that, which by theft hee gote from Abbeyes and the houses of riche Carles: whome Maior blameth for his rapine and theft: but of all theeues hee affirmeth him to be the Prince, and the most gentle Theefe.

King Richarde betooke the guyding of this lande to William Longchamp Bishoppe of Ely, Chauncellour of England, and the foure and twentieth day of Februarie, he tooke his scrippe and staffe at Canterburie, and the 6. of March tooke the Sea at Douer, and transported ouer. 1190 Gouernour of England. William Bishop of Ely.

The seconde of July the two kings of Englande and of Fraunce mette at Towers, and from thence set forward on their iourney towards Ierusalem. K. Rich. tooke his voiage ouer to Ieculalem. Gerualsius. Ypodigma.

The Towne of Wawling in Kent with the Nunnery was consumed with fire.

Off a false owtlay, [callid Robyn Hode,]
Was takyn ȝisterday.

43 'He robbyt me and my felowes boþe
Of twenti marke in serten;
If þat false owtlay be takyn,
Ffor soþe we wolde be fayn.'

44 'So did he me,' seid þe munke,
'Of a hundred pound and more;
I layde furst hande hym apon,
ȝe may thonke me þerfore.'

45 'I pray God thanke you,' seid Litull John,
'And we wil when we may;
We wil go with you, with your leve,
And bryng yow on your way.

46 'Ffor Robyn Hode hase many a wilde felow,
I tell you in certen;
If þei wist ȝe rode þis way,
In feith ȝe shulde be slayn.'

47 As þei went talking be þe way,
The munke and Litull John,
John toke þe munkis horse be þe hede,
Fful sone and anon.

48 Johne toke þe munkis horse be þe hed,
Ffor soþe as I yow say;
So did Much þe litull page,
Ffor he shulde not scape away.

49 Be þe golett of þe hode
John pulled þe munke down;
John was nothyng of hym agast,
He lete hym falle on his crown.

50 Litull John was so[re] agrevyd,
And drew owt his swerde in hye;
This munke saw he shulde be ded,
Lowd mercy can he crye.

51 'He was my maister,' seid Litull John,
'Þat þou hase browȝt in bale;
Shalle þou neuer cum at our kyng,
Ffor to telle hym tale.'

52 John smote of þe munkis hed,
No longer wolde he dwell;
So did Moch þe litull page,
Ffor ferd lest he wolde tell.

53 Þer þei beryed hem boþe,
In nouþer mosse nor lyng,
And Litull John and Much infere
Bare þe letturs to oure kyng.

54 . . . . . .
He knelid down vpon his kne:
'God ȝow saue, my lege lorde,
Ihesus yow saue and se!

55 'God yow saue, my lege kyng!'
To speke John was full bolde;
He gaf hym þe letturs in his hond,
The kyng did hit vnfold.

56 Þe kyng red þe letturs anon,
And seid, So mot I the,
Þer was neuer ȝoman in mery Inglond
I longut so sore to se.

57 'Wher is þe munke þat þese shuld haue browȝt?'
Oure kyng can say:
'Be my trouth,' seid Litull John,
'He dyed after þe way.'

58 Þe kyng gaf Moch and Litul Jon
Twenti pound in sertan,
And made þeim ȝemen of þe crown,
And bade þeim go agayn.

59 He gaf John þe seel in hand,
The sheref for to bere,
To bryng Robyn hym to,
And no man do hym dere.

60 John toke his leve at oure kyng,
Þe sothe as I yow say;
Þe next way to Notyngham
To take, he ȝede þe way.

61 Whan John came to Notyngham
The ȝatis were sparred ychon;
John callid vp þe porter,
He answerid sone anon.

62 'What is þe cause,' seid Litul Jon,
'Þou sparris þe ȝates so fast?'
'Because of Robyn Hode,' seid [þe] porter,
'In depe prison is cast.

63 'John and Moch and Wyll Scathlok,
Ffor sothe as I yow say,

'Robin Hood and the Monk' (Child 119), in F. J. Child, The English and Scottish Popular Ballads, vol. 3 (1888), p. 99 · Internet Archive · Reproduction